

Vancouver, Canada

linkedin.com/in/jwatt-001

buildplayiterate.com

SUMMARY

25+ Years AAA
Game and Level Design
Technical Design
Experienced Developer
Cross-Discipline Leader
Value-Driven

DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Singleplayer
Multiplayer PvE + PvP
Character, Camera, Controls
Combat & AI
Level & World Design
Missions & Quests
Progression & Meta
Sandbox & Systems
Tutorials & Onboarding
UI + UX
Live Service & Social
Prototypes & Demos

DEV SKILLS

Unreal, Unity, Godot,
Frostbite
Blueprint, Python, Lua
JavaScript, Git, WWW
AI-Assisted Development
Tools & Pipelines
Feature Planning +
Roadmaps
Jira, Confluence, Miro, Figma

Jordan Watt

Principal Designer · Game, Level, and Technical Design

An analytical mind with a passion for crafting immersive experiences

- 25+ years in AAA across 20+ shipped titles
- Seasoned game and technical designer with expertise in design methodology and best practices
- Skilled with Unreal Engine 5 to create rich experiences via Level Design, Blueprint, GAS, and Multiplayer
- Adept at feature development and planning with design, art, and engineering disciplines
- Veteran developer with experience from concept to evergreen live service
- Creative, analytical, team-oriented, player-centric, proactive, and versatile

CAREER EXPERIENCE

Final Strike Games

2026 - Current

Principal Level Designer

Unannounced project

- Designing and building levels from greybox layout through gameplay iteration and polish
- Collaborating across design, art, and engineering to take spaces from concept to playable

People Can Fly

2023 - 2026

Principal Technical Level Designer

Gears of War: E-Day · Versus features & level design, Unreal Engine 5

- Built **4 multiplayer game modes** plus seasonal modes, with visuals, game logic, and special weapons
- Supported **6 versus maps** plus seasonal maps, supporting level designers, building pipelines for map features, and creating dynamic map objects
- **Prototyped Versus UI**, and partnered closely with the UX team to build gameplay-facing HUD, in-world UI elements, and map features
- Architected technical workflows and tools that accelerated level design team productivity, and mentored team members on prototyping and development strategy
- Created gyms and prototypes to enable engineers and artists to test and develop game mode content
- Planned and validated features and roadmaps, collaborating across disciplines to identify requirements and mitigate risk

Sumo Digital

2021 - 2023

Principal Technical Designer

Unannounced AAA multiplayer title, Unreal Engine 5

- Led the team responsible for delivering a deeply-integrated core gameplay feature, planning features, milestone deliverables, and roadmaps
- Built comprehensive systemic prototypes in UE5 and Blueprint, coordinating design, engineering, and content teams to prove out features and inform production roadmaps
- Validated and translated design intent into technical requirements and production pipelines
- Provided guidance to designers on best practices in implementation, scripting, and workflows
- Managed, coached, and career-planned multiple Technical Designers; helped define TD department foundations, career paths, and performance standards

Microsoft · The Coalition

2020 - 2021

Senior Game Designer (contract)

Gears 5

- Designed and built multiplayer maps for PvP and PvE modes, taking them from greybox concept to release following the established Gears level design process
- Configured maps for multiplayer (spawners, cinematics, cameras, navmesh, and collision) and maintained gameplay integrity through art production
- Built concept prototype levels and feature gyms for an unannounced UE5 project

SHIPPED CREDITS

DESIGN

Gears of War: E-Day

Gears 5

PvZ: Battle for Neighborville

Star Wars Battlefront 2

FIFA 17

PvZ: Garden Warfare 2

Battlefield: Hardline

NFS: Rivals

Medal of Honor: Warfighter

Army of Two: Devil's Cartel

NFS: The Run

Skate 1, 2, 3, Skate-It

QA MANAGEMENT

FIFA 2007

Battlefield 2: Modern

Combat

Medal of Honor: Heroes

NFS: Most Wanted

QA

NFS: Underground 2

FIFA Soccer 2005

MVP Baseball 2004

NHL 2003

EDUCATION

DeVry Institute of

Technology, 1997 - 2000

B.Sc. Electronics Engineering
Technology

Microprocessors, Circuit

Design, Network

Communications, Signal

Processing, Programming

Faculty Assistant: graded

and proctored exams,

supported students in lab

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

Electronics, Gardening,

Walks, Star Wars, Toys, RPGs,

Board Games, Sports, Space,

Science, Nature, History,

Lego, Zombies

Jordan Watt

Principal Designer · Game, Level, and Technical Design

EA Vancouver

2013 - 2020

Senior Game Designer

PvZ: Battle for Neighborville · Star Wars Battlefront 2 · FIFA 17 · Battlefield: Hardline · NFS: Rivals

- Led design of 'Monthly Activities' for PvZ: Battle for Neighborville, overseeing another designer and creating a repeatable recipe for live seasonal events
- Built boss encounters scaling for 1-4 players, scripted character abilities and AI behaviors, and partnered with UX on progression systems, in-game storefronts, and game mode UI
- Designed and scripted missions for Star Wars Battlefront 2; represented EA Vancouver in cross-studio collaboration with EA Motive, establishing contacts and review pipelines
- Mentored and coached designers, and created processes for prototype and feature development
- Prototyped environments, gameplay, UI, and systemic player tools across linear and open-world games

EA Blackbox

2006 - 2013

Game Designer

Skate 1, 2, 3 · Skate-It · NFS: The Run · Medal of Honor: Warfighter · Army of Two: Devil's Cartel

- Designed and constructed challenges, levels, missions, races, and features across Skate, Need For Speed, Medal of Honor, and Army of Two
- Challenge Design POC for Skate 1, 2, and 3, with an aptitude for compelling challenges and the technical workflows behind them
- Designed Skate 3's Skate School tutorials featuring Coach Frank (Jason Lee), the Skate Park Editor for Skate-It NDS, and Need For Speed: The Run's Challenge Series events
- Represented Skate 3 at EA's London launch showcase: media interviews, hands-on demos, and co-hosting the Hall of Meat tournament

EA Canada

2003 - 2006

QA Development Manager

- Managed **30+ QA testers across 10+ projects**, coordinating Online and Compliance testing for console and mobile titles through the online gaming revolution: PC to PS2 and PSP, and on to the launch of Xbox Online and Xbox 360
- Created and led the Submission Audit Team to pre-test projects and catch critical, costly issues ahead of certification; built the test plan from EA's historical first- and third-party certification data and issued a submission confidence report per project
- Oversaw the Online Clean Room originally created around my own testing work, and built lasting contacts across EA's central technology teams

EA Canada

2001 - 2003

QA Tester

- Operated the 'Online Clean Room', testing Xbox, PlayStation, and PC titles for connectivity and performance, including the EA Sports Online platform, an early framework of Ultimate Team

Nortel Networks

2000 - 2001

Cell Tower CDMA Systems Technologist

- Tested and troubleshoot CDMA cell towers, running test procedures on base station transceiver units; completed floor safety and compliance certifications including ISO 9000

BEYOND THE STUDIO

- **JW Mouse Highlighter** (Python desktop utility, installer + system tray) and **Infinite Wordle** (Godot, exported to HTML): small tools and games built for the joy of shipping
- **SlateShowdown.com** and **buildplayiterate.com**, self-built and self-hosted: automated NHL data scraping (Node, Express, React) and this portfolio (Astro, Cloudflare)
- **Rapid Prototyping Initiative**: pitched augmenting EA's developers with the company's own catalog alongside a Strategic Development Director; built two games at EA's global game jam, reached the finals, and placed runner-up

